

‘We have understood the Indian consumer very well’

Acer India on becoming No 2 in PC market and what comes next

Aman Rashid | editor@digit.in

Acer has been steadily strengthening its position in India's PC market, with the company now ranking as the country's second-largest PC maker. This is all because Acer is expanding its physical retail footprint, particularly in smaller cities, while betting on AI PCs, premium laptops, and gaming to drive the next phase of growth.

I had the chance to speak with Acer's Chief Sales Officer in India, Sanjeev Mehtani, about what is behind the company's momentum, why physical stores still matter, the premium laptop market, and how Acer plans to reach more consumers beyond India's biggest cities. Here are the key excerpts.

Q Acer has become the #2 PC brand in India. What has driven this growth, and can you sustain this momentum?

A Sanjeev: First of all, you require market understanding for becoming number one, number two, number three, or number four, for that matter. I think Acer has been very close to market understanding. Acer understood the Indian consumer very well, what they require, and therefore the products we bring in are connecting with them. The credit goes to our technology and our products, which have

enabled us to go to the market where the requirement is and cater to that requirement.

The second point is that we have been available in multiple segments.

Whether you take government, PSU, banking, or education, we are very large. We are also present in enterprise, SMB, and consumer, across various segments, whether non-gaming or gaming. This very clearly shows that we have a very diverse portfolio available to us, and that is one of the major reasons why we are leading today.

Acer has never gone in for number two or number three positioning. We have always gone in for sustained growth. We have always gone in for good business, and we always believe that business has to be business-like. That is our philosophy, and that is one achievement for sure.

Q Do you think Indian consumers are actually ready to pay more for AI features?

A Sanjeev: AI adoption is actually moving. If you look at the last year and the figures, the market has adopted AI hardware. So if we are talking about AI hardware enablement, then I am saying we will be on the right course.

However, my view on this is that what the consumer is going to get from this AI adoption in terms of creativity, performance, and productivity will be very important. What kind of tools will be available is still maturing.

The market is maturing, not just when the tools are introduced. I think this is a growth area for all of us.

AI on the server side: you have seen what kind of enablement is being done. This part will grow. But, more AI tools that are going to enhance productivity for consumers and help them daily will be required, and that is happening.



Sanjeev Mehtani
Chief Sales Officer,
Acer India

Q How do you see the premium PC market growing in India?

A Sanjeev: India is a growing economy. This is what we talk about with a growing economy: spending increases. Money is available to the consumer to spend and to achieve their aspirations. What people are aspiring for today is better performance and better design. They are aspiring for a better look and feel. They are not only looking for a better look and feel, but aspiring to actually have better performance every time. The tools that are coming in require better productivity and performance.

If all this has to be put together, premium is going to grow. It is growing today, and it is going to grow more.

Even when we were talking about AI adoption, AI adoption is also actually bringing in premiumness. That part goes hand in hand. Though Acer is trying to bring in AI not as the only feature in a premium laptop, we are also trying to bring it into other price ranges and categories.

However, the premium part will definitely go hand in hand as far as AI is concerned. **d**